

Windows

+ Driving slow

My computer, with Windows 95 installed, has become very slow. When I run my computer in safe mode and open the system icon in the Control Panel, in the Performance tab, I see the following errors:

1. "Compatibility mode paging reduces overall system performance. Windows was unable to identify a real-mode driver or memory-resident program loaded in your Config.sys or Autoexec.bat file.

You will see another message that lists the name of the driver or program causing the problem. Because Windows could not identify the driver or program, it has switched to MS-DOS compatibility mode to ensure the program will run.

However, this slows down overall performance. To improve performance, remove the program or driver causing the problem, or contact its manufacturer for an updated version."

2. "Drive X: using MS-DOS compatibility mode file system. This problem often occurs on more than one drive. Usually it is caused by a driver in Config.sys that Windows doesn't recognise, and is related to the problem 'Compatibility mode paging reduces overall system performance.'

If you also see that problem, see the Help for that problem first. If you only see this message on one drive, that drive is using an MS-DOS compatibility (real-mode) driver, which may slow down access to that drive.

Contact your hardware manufacturer to see if an updated driver is available for your drive. If not, the drive may work more slowly than is optimal, but you can still use it."

Munish,
via e-mail

R Windows 95 uses the MS-DOS compatibility mode when it is not using 16 or 32-bit disk access drivers. To fix the problems, you could try the following:

Go to Start > Run. Type regedit and click OK. In Registry Editor, click on Edit > Find. Type noide and click on Find Next. Delete all the entries that you find. Reboot the machine.

If this does not work, go to Start > Settings > Control Panel > System. In the Device Manager tab, check if the Primary and Secondary IDE channels have any conflicts (exclamation marks next to them). Select Standard IDE/ESDI Hard Disk Controller and click Remove.

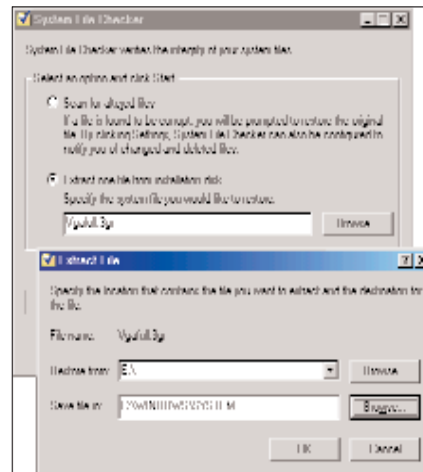
Reboot the system. Windows should detect the Primary IDE channel. Don't allow Windows to reboot, and let it detect the Secondary IDE channel. Now continue to boot into Windows 95 and then reboot from the Shutdown menu. If this too does not work, you should format the hard disk and repartition using fdisk.

Windows

+ Truant files

I have a Pentium II 333 MHz, 48x CD-ROM system. When I try to play VCDs through Windows Media Player 7, it displays an error message, 'A device attached to the system is not functioning'. When I try to enter into MS-DOS prompt from Windows 98, I get a similar error message and another which says, 'The object that MS-DOS prompt refers has been inaccessible or removed'. What may be the error? How can I overcome it?

Sivapadmanaban,
via e-mail



Specifying the source and destination for the damaged or missing files

R It seems that you have a damaged or missing Vgafull.3gr file or Wino386.mod file in the Windows\System folder. To solve the problem, you should rename these two files (use the Find tool) and extract the correct files using WinZip or System File Checker.

To open the System File Checker, go to Start > Run and type sfc; click on OK. Select the 'Extract one file from installation disk' radio button and type out the file you want to extract.

Clicking on Start will bring up a dialog

box that will ask for the source and the destination of the file you are extracting. This should solve the problem.

Windows

+ Added options

When I right-click on Start, I can see the options Open, Explore, and Find in the context menu. Can I add more options to this context menu, which can open applications?

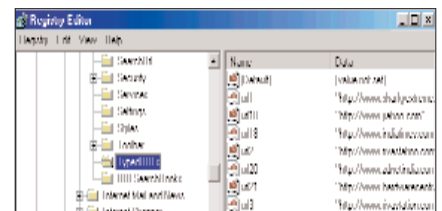
Satish and Sanju,
via e-mail

R Yes, you can add your own options in this context menu. To do so, open Windows Explorer. Go to View > Folder Options > File Types. Here, click on Folder and click Edit. Now click on New and specify a name for the action that would appear in the menu. Also specify the program that would execute this action. Click OK, and close. You will now see your own option in the context menu.

Internet and communications

+ Clear URLs

When you click on the drop-down button in Internet Explorer's address bar, you can see a



Deleting select URLs from Internet Explorer

list of all the URLs that you have visited. Is it possible to selectively clear URLs from this drop-down list? I do not want to get rid of all the URLs by doing a Clear History.

Gaurav,
via e-mail

R You can edit the registry to do this, or use software that allows you to do so. However, backup your registry before editing it. Here's what you should do: Go to Start > Run. Type regedit and click OK. Go to HKEY_Current_User\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Typed URLs\.

Here, you will find many URLs. Just select the ones that you do not need and delete them. Make sure that your IE is not running. Exit the registry and restart Windows. The URLs should be gone.

DO YOU NEED HELP?

Send an SOS to sos@jasubhai.com

Or write in to DIGIT, D-222/2, Om Sagar Bldg, MIDC, Nerul-400 706